

» CATS

sandy
coloured coatround head
with erect earslarge canine
teeth for
killing prey0.9–1.6 m
2¾–5¼ ftlong hind legs for
exceptional sprinting
and leaping power49–83 cm
19½–33 in**PUMA***Puma concolor*

Also known as the cougar, panther, and mountain lion, the puma occupies rugged terrain across a vast range from Canada to Argentina.

JAGUARUNDI*Herpailurus yagouaroundi*

One of the largest and most widespread S. American cats, the jaguarundi hunts small mammals by day in diverse habitats.

HYENAS AND AARDWOLF

The small family of Hyaenidae contains three species of scavenging hyena and the aardwolf, which specializes in eating insects. Hyenas are characterized by a stocky, doglike body with short hind legs and powerful bone-crushing jaws. They are highly intelligent and live in family groups, called clans.

AARDWOLF*Proteles cristata*

This dainty, weak-jawed cousin of the hyenas eats only insects. It lives in southern and E. Africa in the dry grassland favoured by termites.

55–80 cm
22–31 inpowerful
neck and
forequarters**SPOTTED HYENA***Crocuta crocuta*

This efficient scavenger is also a proficient hunter of ungulates. It lives in unforested areas of sub-Saharan Africa.

1.3–1.6 m
4¼–5¼ ft1–1.2 m
3¼–4 ft**STRIPED HYENA***Hyaena hyaena*

The small striped hyena is found in open country from N. Africa to India. It eats a mixed diet of scavenged meat, small prey animals, and fruits.

1.1–1.4 m
3½–4½ ft**BROWN HYENA***Hyaena brunnea*

This social southern African scavenger survives desert conditions by foraging at night and supplementing its diet with watery fruits.

